TPF induction: docetaxel, cisplatin and fluorouracil

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00315 · Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before the first visit

Confirm the exact regimen, treatment aim, baseline tests, transport, support medicines and verified urgent contact numbers. Bring a full medicine list and any hearing, nerve or swallowing concerns.

STEP 2

Time in the unit

Day 1 includes docetaxel over 60 minutes and cisplatin over 1 hour, plus prescribed fluids, premedication and anti-sickness treatment. Fluorouracil 1,000 mg/m² per day runs continuously over 96 hours on Days 1–4; the source also allows a separate 22-hour infusion on each of those four days. Total attendance is longer than the drug infusion alone. Confirm inpatient or outpatient arrangements, any pump changes and final disconnection.

STEP 3

Keeping appointments together

Keep one calendar for blood tests, treatment and any radiation, dental, nutrition or swallowing appointments. If an appointment is cancelled, ask the relevant teams to agree the revised plan.

STEP 4

Practical help

Tell the team about travel, cost, work, caring responsibilities, communication or reading needs. Ask whether a support person or interpreter can attend and how treatment changes will be explained.

STEP 5

Leaving the unit

Check the next blood-test and treatment dates, medicine instructions and whom to call if unwell. Have the service confirm the daytime, out-of-hours and backup contact routes.

Sources: NCCP 00315 v7a: official regimen. Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.